

Policy Name: House Rules for Grand Council Conventions

Effective Date: 1991

Revised: March 2007, June 2009, September 2009, July 2013, July 2016, December 2018, April 2024, June 2026

Purpose

- To establish standard House Rules for the Grand Council Convention including procedural operations for the business meeting
- These House Rules are subordinate to and shall not conflict with the Constitution and By-Laws of Kappa Psi Pharmaceutical Fraternity, Inc.
- In the event of a conflict, the Constitution & By-Laws shall prevail

Policy/Procedure

Credentials Committee

- A Credentials Committee shall be established for each Grand Council Convention as an ad hoc committee.
- The Committee shall be responsible for verifying delegate credentials, confirming eligibility to serve as a delegate and vote at the Grand Council Convention based on records maintained by the Central Office, and reporting the official voting strength of the Grand Council prior to the opening of the first business session and updating that report at the opening of each subsequent session.
- The Committee shall apply eligibility requirements to serve as a delegate and vote at Grand Council Convention as set forth in the Constitution & By-Laws of Kappa Psi Pharmaceutical Fraternity, Inc.
- The Committee shall be appointed by the Grand Regent.
- The Committee shall confirm the status of quorum at the opening of each business session and every session thereafter.
- The Committee shall be responsible for the coordination of any voting mechanism used during the Convention.
- The Committee shall verify the eligibility of any designated proxy delegate and include all approved proxies in the official voting strength report.

Delegates & Attendance

- The seating of Delegates at all sessions of the Grand Council shall be in alphabetical order:
 - Collegiate Chapters shall be seated first according to the Greek Alphabet
 - Graduate Chapters shall be seated next according to the English Alphabet
 - Provinces shall be seated next according to the English Alphabet
 - International Executive Committee Officers shall be seated next according to manner listed in the Constitution.
 - Past Grand Regents and then Editor of The MASK shall be seated last according to English Alphabet by last name
 - Random seating of Voting Delegates shall not be permitted.
 - Delegates for Chapters will only be seated after being verified by the Credentials Committee. A delegate may only sit for a Chapter on whose roster they are listed, provided they meet the other requirements for Chapter

membership as outlined by the Constitution & By-Laws.

- Delegate eligibility will be based on the roster on file with the Central Office that they have validated for the year of the convention. Any roster updates must be submitted no later than the date of submission of delegate forms.
- There shall be a roll call of Chapters, Provinces, and other voting members, attendance noted, and reported, at the beginning of each session.
 - No session of the Grand Council shall be opened unless a quorum is present as defined in accordance with the Constitution & By-Laws
 - Absence from more than one (1) session of the Grand Council shall be a valid reason for possible reduction or elimination of travel reimbursement paid by the Fraternity to a Chapter.
- All Officers and Members of the International Executive Committee shall be present at all meetings of the Grand Council.
 - Absence from more than one (1) session of the Grand Council shall be a valid reason for possible reduction or elimination of travel reimbursement paid by the Fraternity in accordance with established reimbursement policies.
 - The only exception of this rule shall be when the Member's presence is required at another function of the Grand Council which is coincidental with the meeting or at the direction of the Grand Regent.

Right to the Floor & Debate

- On any given debatable item, the total debate time shall be limited to twenty (20) minutes.
 - Each speaker shall be allowed a maximum of two (2) minutes with an additional one (1) minute to be allotted at the option of the Chairperson.
 - Speakers may proceed in any order; however, at the option of the Chairperson, debate may be made in alternating pro and con order.
 - Time limits shall be kept by the Chairperson or their assigned agent.
- Debate of an item will end upon reaching 20 minutes and noted by the Chairperson.
- Any Member wishing to speak on an issue shall proceed to an assigned podium and await recognition by the Chairperson. Upon recognition, the Member may address the Grand Council.
 - At all times during all meetings of the Grand Council, use of the floor shall be restricted to voting members of the Grand Council and others recognized by the Chairperson for official business with proper dignity and decorum being maintained.

Legislative Proposals

- Legislative proposals that have been properly submitted and made available to the Grand Council in accordance with the Constitution & By-Laws and the procedures of the International Legislative Committee shall not be required to be read in full prior to consideration by the Grand Council unless requested by the body

Decorum

- There shall be no alcoholic beverages or other substances that may impair judgment or cognition present in the meeting room during sessions of the Grand Council

Convention.

- No member will be admitted to any meeting who is intoxicated.
- At all times during all meetings, those in attendance shall be sober and properly dressed:
 - Members are expected to wear professional attire or appropriate Kappa Psi attire during all business sessions.
 - No member will be admitted to any meeting who exhibits a bare chest and/or bare feet.
- No photographs taken or videos made at any Grand Council Convention sessions may be sold without an official contract with the Fraternity.
- All cellphones and electronic devices must be kept on silent during all sessions.
- There shall be no campaign materials permitted on the Grand Council Convention site or surrounding areas during the Grand Council Convention. Communication regarding candidates is only permitted under official election procedures established by the Fraternity. Violations and any questions or concerns will be addressed by the Executive Director.
- Any member or guest in attendance that is warned for excessive noise or disturbing other hotel guests will be subject to removal at the discretion of the hotel and/or Grand Regent or Executive Director.
- If the member who is asked to leave is a collegiate, the Dean of their school/college will be notified of such an occurrence. If the hotel issues a complimentary room credit to a guest due to a Member's disruptive conduct, the Member's Chapter shall be responsible for that cost and will be billed by The Central Office. Members or guests not affiliated with a Chapter may be billed directly.
- All physical, electronic or media items presented, sold or marketed at the Grand Council Convention must be approved by the Central Office or appropriate designated individual prior to the start of the Convention

Policy Violation

- Failure to follow any of the Kappa Psi Policies may result, at the direction of the Grand Regent, in the Member's removal from the meeting.
- Removal of a Member may be subject to appeal to the Grand Council.
- Any reported policy violations may be made known in open session in order to bring attention to the violation and to ensure it does not happen again.

Suspending the Rules

- The House Rules of the Grand Council Convention may be suspended by a three-fourths (3/4) vote of the Members of the Grand Council, provided that such suspension does not conflict with the Constitution & By-Laws of Kappa Psi Pharmaceutical Fraternity, Inc.
- Rules relating to decorum, conduct, member behavior, and policy violations shall not be subject to suspension under any circumstances.
- The presiding Chairperson shall determine whether a rule is procedural in nature and therefore eligible for suspension, subject to appeal by the Grand Council.